

HONOR IN FIRE BUILDING

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WHAT IS FIRE BUILDING?

Fire building is the skill of making and controlling fire safely for useful purposes such as warmth, light, cooking, protection, and signaling. It involves choosing a safe place, arranging firewood correctly, lighting the fire properly, and putting it out safely after use.

TYPES OF CAMP FIRES

1. CRISS-CROSS FIRE

Firewood placed crosswise.

Allows good air circulation.

Produces strong flames.

Used mainly for warmth and light, not for cooking.

2. PYRAMID FIRE

Firewood arranged in a pyramid shape.

Produces strong flames and heat.

Used mainly for warmth and lighting, not suitable for cooking.

3. HUNTER'S FIRE

Two large logs placed parallel.

Fire burns between the logs.

Used for controlled cooking.

4. STAR FIRE

Logs arranged like the spokes of a star.

Logs are pushed inward as they burn.

Saves firewood.

Common in villages and an old traditional way of cooking.

5. TEEPEE (CONE) FIRE

Firewood arranged in a cone shape.

Lights easily and burns quickly.

Used for quick heat and light.

6. LOG CABIN FIRE

Firewood stacked like a box.

Burns evenly.

Produces steady heat.

7. REFLECTOR FIRE

Fire built in front of logs or a wall.

Heat is reflected forward.

Used mainly for warmth.

8. TRENCH FIRE

Fire built in a shallow trench.

Protected from wind.

Suitable for windy areas.

9. SIGNAL FIRE

Built to produce smoke.

Used for emergency signaling.

10. KEYHOLE FIRE

Shaped like a keyhole.

Allows cooking and warming at the same time.

11. DAKOTA FIRE HOLE

Fire built underground.

Uses less wood.

Produces little smoke.

USES OF FIRE IN CAMP

Fire is used in camp for:

Cooking food

Providing warmth

Giving light at night

Drying clothes

Protection from wild animals

Emergency signaling

FIRE BUILDING UNDER WET CONDITIONS (TIPS)

Use dry wood from inside fallen logs or under tree bark.

Collect wood from sheltered places.

Use dry grass, leaves, or paper as tinder.

Build the fire on raised ground or stones.

Protect the fire from rain and wind.

Start with small firewood and add larger pieces gradually.

FIRE SAFETY RULES

Build fire away from tents and trees.

Clear dry leaves around the fire area.

Never leave fire unattended.

Keep water or sand nearby.

Put out the fire completely after use.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

1. Define fire building.
2. Name four types of camp fires.
3. State two uses of fire in camp.
4. Which fire is commonly used in villages?
5. Explain how to build fire under wet conditions.
6. State four fire safety rules.

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